

Consciousness Science 2026 budget

IONS

Consciousness Science 2026

conference date Oct 10 - 16 2026

Worksheet for Financial Risk Assessment

pb Andrea Livingston & Johnny Calvert Mar 18 2026

Scenario description applicable to both columns below:

IONS would delegate the work out, and primarily include
Abi Behar, Arnaud Delorme, and Andrea Livingston managing,
with Thomas, Claudia, and CFO supporting, and
with minimal support from IONS E&E and Advancement Teams.

500 registrants = conservative most likely

700 - 800 registrants = historically typical

Income:

in-person tickets
student passes
day passes
livestream online tickets
Thursday dinner - based on 50% of registrants
exhibitor booths

sponsorships

Total Income

Expenses:

Staff

Independent Contractor - Conference Lead
(IONS staff time is not accounted for)

Venue

contracted total rooms hotel revenue of \$461,000 X 85% =
\$392,000 minimum to avoid hotel attrition penalties;

350 rooms X 85% = 298 rooms minimum to avoid penalties
attrition offset based on the minimum 298 rooms booked

note: Total Income above includes conference tickets only, as
registrants would pay the hotel directly for their rooms.
Therefore, the number of tickets sold does not necessarily
equate to the number of rooms booked. Paradise Point San
Diego offers 462 bungalow-style rooms and suites.

Food & Beverages

F&B Minimum
27% service charge
8% sales tax
bartending labor - \$200 per cash bar

Production & Audio Visual

A/V - as quoted per independent contractor
A/V - hotel coordinator (\$7200 vs \$1500 pending negotiation)
post production

Travel & Transportation

A/V Team, Conference Lead, Volunteers
Plenary speakers
IONS Staff

Hotelling

A/V Team, Conference Lead, Volunteers
Plenary speakers
IONS Staff

Other Expenses

Marketing - to be determined
Event Liability Insurance
badges & lanyards

Scenario 1: 350 tickets sold and minimum rooms bookings of 298 met under 350 rooms contract

#	\$ each	\$ total
350	550	192,500
50	450	22,500
0	250	0
100	118	11,800
175	150	26,250
10	2,500	25,000
		278,050

85,000

392,000

(392,000)

150,000
40,500
12,000
1,000

83,000
7,200
4,000

10,000
25,000
6,000

15,000
37,500
15,000

15,000
750
3,000

Scenario 1: 500 tickets sold and minimum rooms bookings of 298 met under 350 rooms contract

#	\$ each	\$ total
500	550	275,000
50	450	22,500
0	250	0
100	118	11,800
250	150	37,500
10	2,500	25,000
		371,800

85,000

392,000

(392,000)

150,000
40,500
12,000
1,000

83,000
7,200
4,000

10,000
25,000
6,000

15,000
37,500
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Oxford abstracts / scientists & speakers
 signage
 IONS exhibitor booth

Total Expenses

Net Income (Loss)

Scenario 1: 350 tickets sold and minimum rooms bookings of 298 met under 350 rooms contract			Scenario 1: 500 tickets sold and minimum rooms bookings of 298 met under 350 rooms contract		
#	\$ each	\$ total	#	\$ each	\$ total
		890			890
		3,000			3,000
		2,000			2,000
		515,840			515,840
		(237,790)			(144,040)

Hotel Deposits:

25% upon signing
 50% of remaining - April 13 2026
 remaining balance - 21 days prior to arrival

\$	51,000	\$	51,000
\$	77,000	\$	77,000

Cancellation Penalties:

upon signing - 70% of total revenue
 Apr 4 - Jul 12 - 80% of total revenue
 Jul 13 - Oct 10 - 90% of total revenue

\$	428,000	\$	428,000
\$	489,000	\$	489,000
\$	550,000	\$	550,000

Additional scenarios that would include increasing levels of support and programmatic involvement by IONS is not included here as that would require substantially more Teams-based input than is possible ahead of this March 20 meeting. J Calvert

If ticket prices increased from \$550 to \$650, Net Income =	\$	(202,790)	\$	(94,000)
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Summary of the table with the \$650 ticket price

- Loss of \$203k for 350 participants
- Loss of \$94k for 500 participants

Remediation 1: removing optional expenses

- Budget includes \$41,000 optional IONS related expense (marketing, staff travel)
- Contractor for 1 year (\$85k) but 1/2 year is possible in worst case scenario (\$42.5k)
- Budget includes ~\$20k for volunteer travel and hotel (volunteers can be local)
- With these removed, the budget is balanced at 500 tickets (profit of \$9.7k)

Remediation 2: more than 500 participants

- The conference usually brings more than 700 people (this is without IONS advertising it to its constituents) and has always made money
- With 200 people more, the conference will bring an additional \$130k

Remediation 3: bring in fully vetted sponsors

- Cyan Banister has pledged \$50k (see Sponsor tab)
- Eugene Jhong has pledge to balance the budget up to \$200k loss (see Sponsor tab)